

Unit –VI: Seeking Support and Final Project

Mentors help to create successful startups,

Identify mentors and advisors,

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Contents of capstone project

Mentors Help to Create successful Startups

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- Proper and timely mentoring is very crucial for any start-up (especially a technology startup). Focused mentoring from experienced people could be helpful at almost all activities of a start-up, such as formulating the business plan, product development, business development, team-building, fund-raising, marketing, etc.
- Mentors are successful and experienced people (role models) willing to share or impart knowledge, wisdom and advice on to those less experienced, in this case, entrepreneurs of startup companies on a voluntary basis as often a longer term relationship.
- Business mentors are people who have knowledge and experience that they can use to help other people develop their careers through personal and professional development. They often act as role models.
- A business mentor is someone with higher level of entrepreneurial business experience that an entrepreneur can trust with confidence over an extended period of time, usually free of charge.
- A mentee is someone who has identified a specific personal or professional goal and who believes that the guidance and help of a mentor can help in achieving the goals.

Mentors Help to Create successful Startups

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- “Mentorship is a critical component for building a successful startup. Having a good product or service that fills a void in the marketplace is great, but a good mentor is crucial to help you grow.” DAVE SCHNEIDER
- A good mentor talks from experience, and shares it in a truthful way so that it can be of help to the mentee;
- Listens to the entrepreneur and gathers all the information to give advice later on;
- Empathizes with the challenges faced by the entrepreneur and shares his or her experiences;
- Is capable of establishing trusting long term relationships;
- Enjoys contributing to the growth of the entrepreneur;
- Motivates and channels the energy of the entrepreneur towards his or her objectives.
- The usefulness of the mentor also depends on the entrepreneur. Building a business is not an exact science and professionals must be capable of listening and knowing what to ignore.

Characteristics of a Good Mentor

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- A desire to help others succeed
- A willingness to pass along information
- A willingness to give and receive feedback
- A desire to work with others
- A desire to engage with others on an interpersonal level
- A desire to learn
- A motivation to mentor
- Good listening and communication skills
- Good questioning skills
- Good common sense
- Good people management and leadership skills
- Knowledge of the industry, organization, or field in which the mentee works or aspires to work in
- Self-confidence and self-awareness
- Strong ethics
- Lack of prejudice
- Openness, honesty and trustworthiness
- Patience
- Empathy

Qualities Needed In A Mentee

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- A willingness to learn about themselves
- A willingness to learn from others' experience
- Commitment to their personal and professional growth
- Strong interpersonal skills
- Good listening skills
- An easy ability to learn
- An open mind and a willingness to try new things
- An ability to accept feedback and learn from it
- Patience and ability to take a long-term view
- Good communication skills
- Flexibility
- Respect for other people's time and effort
- Realistic expectations
- A strong work ethic
- A strong initiative
- A clear commitment to being mentored
- A willingness to take responsibility for their career
- Openness, honesty and trustworthiness

Role of a Mentor

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➤ **Advisor and coach:**

- provide advice, guidance, and feedback;
- share their experience and expertise as appropriate;
- act as a sounding board for ideas and action plans

➤ **Champion and cheerleader:**

- offer encouragement and support to try new things;
- help mentees move out their comfort zones;
- help mentees understand when things do not go as planned;
- act as a role model for the mentee

➤ **Resource and recommendations:**

- identify resources that will help mentees with personal development and growth, such as recommending books, workshops, or other learning tools;

➤ **Devil's advocate and “truth-sayer”:**

- provide the tough feedback that mentees need to hear in order to move forward; push mentees to take risks when appropriate;
- help mentees consider and weigh potential consequences of decisions and actions to avoid the pitfalls and predictable surprises that may occur.

Mentee's Responsibilities

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- Identify initial learning goals and measures of success for the mentoring relationship
- Be open to and seek feedback
- Take an active role in their own learning and help drive the process
- Schedule and attend mentor conversations
- Follow through on commitments and take informed risks as they try new options and behaviors in support of career and development goals.

Strategies For Effective Mentor-Mentee Relationship

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STRATEGIES FOR EFFECTIVE

MENTOR MENTEE RELATIONSHIP

01

COMMIT TO EACH OTHER

02

DEVELOP TRUST

03

PLAN GOALS

04

ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

05

COLLABORATE FOR RESULTS

Strategies For Effective Mentor-Mentee Relationship

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- **Strategy #1: Commit to each other :** It requires dedication and commitment much like any other type of job. Set time boundaries, define protocol to cancel, agree on the medium to contact (email, face to face) depending on the issue. Both mentor and mentee write down their commitments and refer to them from time to time.
- **Strategy #2: Connect to develop a relationship of trust:** Both mentor and mentee must align on their principles and values to mutually benefit from the relationship. Without establishing them first, a value clash later may cause feelings that can obstruct both sides to continue effectively.

Strategies For Effective Mentor-Mentee Relationship

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- **Strategy #3: Plan to establish goals and define roles and responsibilities:** A mentor mentee relationship that's based on ad hoc needs without establishing clear goals does not last long. It is necessary to know what the mentee wants to learn and not what mentor wants to teach.
- **Strategy #4: Collaborate to achieve results:** A great plan is of no use without putting it into action. Set a clear meeting agenda and be prepared for a productive discussion based on earlier agreement of roles and responsibilities. Be receptive to each other's ideas, work collaboratively to brainstorm them, identify roadblocks and then determine which one to put into action.

Strategies For Effective Mentor-Mentee Relationship

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- **Strategy # 5 The journey itself is the reward:** The mentor mentee relationship does not end once mentee achieves their desired goals. People remember good mentors and mentees throughout their life. They cite their examples when talking to others and draw inspiration from them when faced with challenging circumstances.

Mentoring Process

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Society for Innovation and Entrepreneurship (SINE), hosted by Indian Institute of Technology Bombay (IIT Bombay), administers a business incubator that provides support for technology based entrepreneurship, extending the role of IIT Bombay by facilitating the conversion of research activity into entrepreneurial ventures. The mentoring process of SINE is as follows:

- When the incubation of a start-up is being finalized, SINE would recommend a mentor from its list and introduce him/her to the company.
- The promoter's are either free to choose from the said list or are free to have their own mentor albeit with the concurrence of SINE.
- The company and mentor will initially engage with each other to understand the role and contribution that the mentor can make to the company.
- If the arrangement works out positively for the company, the association needs to be formalized with a suitable consideration model so as to ensure continued involvement of the mentor. Such a contract should cover aspects such as:
 - Duration of mentoring relationship
 - Objectives and scope of relationship
 - Confidentiality
 - Frequency and mechanisms of meetings
 - Tacking and review processes

Benefits Of Mentoring Relationship

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A mentoring relationship can provide a mentee with the following:

- Greater clarity on life and career choices and their own career goals
- New insight on the company's culture and organization
- Different perspectives and cultural values
- The opportunity to develop new networks of contacts
- Access to new resources.
- Greater career satisfaction and increased likelihood of career success
- Development in areas not typically address through training or on the job

Identify Mentors and Advisors

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- Advisors are the bloodline of many modern startups.
- Startup advisors are chosen and utilized on a varying range of topics.
- The most common startup advisors are professors, founders and serial founders themselves, with deep expertise of the niche that a company acts in.
- Advisors help businesses with their connections and network,
- They help entrepreneurs find solutions to the issues,
- They provide contacts and channels to partners and investors who may otherwise be reluctant to work with startups.

Compensation for Advisors

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- Startup advisors are looking for a return.
- Most commonly, advisors have an equity stake in the company and are paid \$1,000 upwards, plus expenses, for each meeting to reimburse their time.
- Other advisors will not take a meeting fee and rely on a more generous equity package instead.
- Some advisors go for a monetary meeting and retainer fee may be preferred by others.
- The compensation and service plan is usually detailed in an advisory agreement.

Identify Mentors and Advisors

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- Growth advisors, with deep expertise in marketing and sales help in making the products reach millions of users.
- This is because growth is often the number one priority at startups and hence it is essential to bring on independent and new ideas that can work wonders.
- There are also technical advisors, commonly seen in industries where deep technical expertise is needed or where founders need extra support to push through the challenges.

Compensation for Advisors

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- Startup advisors don't work for free. For the value they provide, they are looking for a return.
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Finding Startup Advisors and Mentors

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There are certain right places where one can find the startup advisors and mentors:

- **Startup networking events:** The events related to meetups, demo days or startup groups. Startup network events are usually where investors and advisors take notice of the ideas from the budding entrepreneurs.
- **Partners:** An entrepreneur may welcome a business partner, customer or supplier and appoint him/her as an advisor or even as an investor. Business partners may also give a good introduction to advisors belonging to an industry.
- **Cold emailing startup advisors:** A good cold email can bring lot of openings to advisors. It is necessary to master the art of writing a good cold email, that would lead to unlimited achievement.

Finding Startup Advisors and Mentors

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- **Online Communities:** Startup events and networking increasingly happen online. There are online communities where engineering students with entrepreneurial mindset share the same space with business owners. People in the right communities love to interact with others. In communities it is possible to find a lot of people with the same mindset.
- **Mentorship Platforms:** Mentorship platforms are one of the easiest ways to connect with an expert for advice. For instance there are apps like GrowthMentor, helping to connect casually to growth and marketing experts who can be booked through the platform.
- **Incubators and accelerators:** Entrepreneurs and Startups can find close 1-to-1 mentorships and advisors if they join a renowned incubator program. For example, YCombinator and Techstars programs each provide a personal advisor after joining their program.

Importance of Mentors and Advisors

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- **Gain experience not shared in books:** Mentorship is one guaranteed way to gain experience from others. Experience is an expensive and crucial for the success of a business. Some personal experiences may be too intimate to be shared, yet how they dealt with it can help an inexperienced entrepreneur's career.
- **The likelihood of success is more with a mentor:** Research and surveys prove that having a mentor is important to success. In a 2013 executive coaching survey, 80 percent of CEOs said they received some form of mentorship. In another research by Sage, 93 percent of startups admit that mentorship is instrumental to success. The valuable connections, timely advice, occasional checks, together with the spiritual and moral guidance provided by a mentor will literally leapfrog an entrepreneur to success.
- **Network opportunities:** Aside the fact that investors trust startups who are recommended by their friends, a successful mentor has an unlimited network of people ready to provide benefits to an entrepreneur. Since advisors are already invested, it only makes sense for them to let an entrepreneur tap into their network of people when the need arises.

Importance of Mentors and Advisors

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- **A mentor gives reassurance:** It has been proven by research that a quality mentorship has a powerful positive effect on young entrepreneurs. Having someone who practically guides and shares the worries of an entrepreneur keeps the entrepreneur reassured and successful. Mentors have the capacity to help young founders tap into their self-confidence and see every challenge as an opportunity.
- **A mentor will help a Startup stay in business longer:** According to Small Business Administration (USA), 30 percent of new businesses may not survive past the first 24 months, and 50 percent of those may not make it past five years. However, 70 percent of mentored businesses survive longer than 5 years.
- **A mentor will help an entrepreneur develop stronger EQ:** Emotional intelligence is crucial to entrepreneurial success. When a young entrepreneur has a more mature and successful mentor who advises them, they are likely to have greater control over their emotions.

Importance of Mentors and Advisors

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- **Encouragement:** In hard times, having a mentor will help an entrepreneur keep his/her head high. Young entrepreneurs often deal with depression when they are unable to meet their goals and expectations. The impact of depression on entrepreneurs is often underreported. But entrepreneurs without mentors bear the brunt the most.
- A mentor who has experienced the highs and lows of running a business is in the perfect position to give positive and soothing words of advice in adverse circumstances. And not only do they have the right words to share, they would also have ideas to help an entrepreneur navigate towards success.

Board of Directors

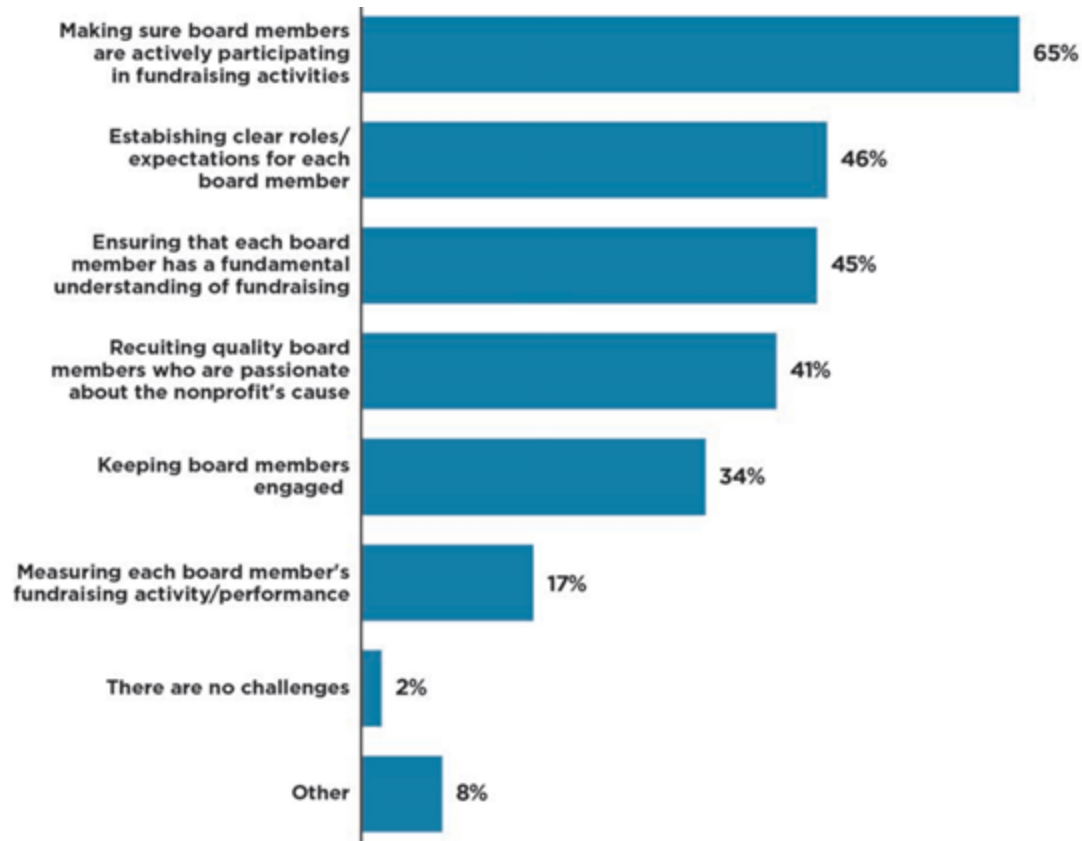
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- The ultimate authority of the Joint Stock Company, lies with the board of directors.
- The directors are elected by the shareholders and they in turn elect the Managing Director.
- However, the authority of the board is subject to the limitations imposed by the Memorandum of Association, Articles of Association of the company and there relevant provisions of the Companies Act, 1956.
- The board of directors act as trustees to the property and welfare of the company.
- The board formulates, reviews and reformulates the company's mission, objectives and policies which forms the basis for strategy formulation and implementation.
- The board designs the structure of the organization based on the objectives and policies.
- The board should assume the responsibility of screening and selecting the top executives.

Scout the Board of Directors

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- An age-old saying “You’re only as good as the people you surround yourself with.”
- **Challenges to Board Effectiveness**



Scout the Board of Directors

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Guidelines for recruiting the Right Board of Directors

- **Writing a recruitment plan:** The responsibilities and time commitment of the board members should be in writing. Advertisement for board position should be released. The compensation for board members should also be mentioned in writing.
- **Putting the role of board members in writing:** Job description of board members should be put in writing, preferably into the business plan. This helps potential board members to check if they are a good fit.
- **Using Personal Networks:** While hiring board members, the company is looking for an entirely different type of person than while hiring for an in-house position. Strong business relationships of a given network should be examined for potential board members.
- **Using board search firms:** Board search firms/companies can be effective in finding board members. However, members who come through search firms, may feel foreign to the startup. Based on the available budget, board search firms can be an option.
- **Aim high:** Aim for the best board members working in the area of the startup. Finding solid board directors is an ongoing process that may not always feel intuitive or natural. However, with a little thought, planning, and social ingenuity, it is possible to get desired advisors or board members needed to run an enterprise.

Overview on Final project

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The objective of the final project is to explore topics in decision making under uncertainty in greater depth than is permitted in class. The choice of topic should be related to the general themes of the course. As part of the project you should:

- describe an approach (existing or newly developed),
- apply the approach to a problem of interest and
- analyze the performance of the approach according to a set of metrics.

The overview of the final project consists of the following:

- 1.Introduction about the company
- 2.Problem
- 3.Solution
- 4.Market size
- 5.Business Model
- 6.HR team
- 7.Competitor Analysis
- 8.Marketing plan
9. Financial Analysis, Revenues generated
- 10.Milestones achieved

Objectives of Final project

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The objectives for the final project are for the student to be able to:

- discuss and explain all of the core concepts introduced in the course;
- write effectively about the project;
- analyze project data and back up conclusions with analysis;
- select a project and acquire the appropriate and relevant data;
- apply the tools and techniques of the course to a realistic project;
- learn enough from an analysis to be able to make useful recommendations about the project; and
- acquire and present the lessons learned

CAPSTONE PROJECT

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- A capstone project is a multifaceted assignment that serves as a culminating academic and intellectual experience for students, typically during their final year of high school or middle school, or at the end of an academic program or learning-pathway experience.
- Capstone projects are generally designed to encourage students to think critically, solve challenging problems, and develop skills such as oral communication, public speaking, research skills, media literacy, teamwork, planning, self-sufficiency, or goal setting
- The CAPSTONE project is a personally-designed independently conducted activity which enables us to further enhance better understanding of the selected project.
- The project represents a significant portion and is therefore expected to represent attainment of final objective.

Capstone Project Presentation

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- As part of the Capstone Project, the new venture consists of
 1. Business model,
 2. Business plan
 3. Growth achieved
 4. Key Learning

Capstone Project Presentation

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➤ As part of the Capstone Project, the new venture consists of

1. Business model,
2. Business plan
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4. Key Learning

Contents of Capstone Project

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- Contents of Capstone Project
 - Introduction of your company
 - Team members
 - The problem you have identified
 - The solution you found
 - Revenue streams
 - Customer Acquisition and CLV

Steps are involved in the CAPSTONE

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- Select about your start up company.
- Determine and identify the deliverables at the end of the project.
- Prepare a brief (one page maximum) CAPSTONE project proposal.
- The proposal must clearly identify the topic chosen and describe the product learnings and product deliverables.
- Submit by your CAPSTONE project proposal for consideration and approval. Proposals requiring rework will be returned with a request for revision and resubmission.
- Once our proposal has been approved, work toward the completion of approved CAPSTONE project activity.
- Submit your CAPSTONE project work-in-progress reports by the specified due dates.
- Develop a computer-based presentation of your CAPSTONE project experience by the specified due date.
- Successfully deliver CAPSTONE project presentation and submission for final evaluation.

CAPSTONE PROJECT PRESENTATION GUIDELINES

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- Title/Topic slide
 - Identifies the Title/Topic of your project
- Project Description
 - Identifies the Product, Method and Relevance as we proposed.
- Outcomes
 - Identifies all significant outcomes (i.e., what was and was not accomplished).
- Lessons Learned
 - Identifies the lessons learned in completing the project as well as any recommendations we have to others who might attempt to complete a similar project.
- Demonstration
 - This is mandatory and should not exceed to time allotted for the presentation. Remember, the slides should contain only an outline and we should elaborate on each point as we present.

CAPSTONE PROJECT - Evaluation Criteria and Schedule of Deliverables

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- Title/Topic slide
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Thank
you!